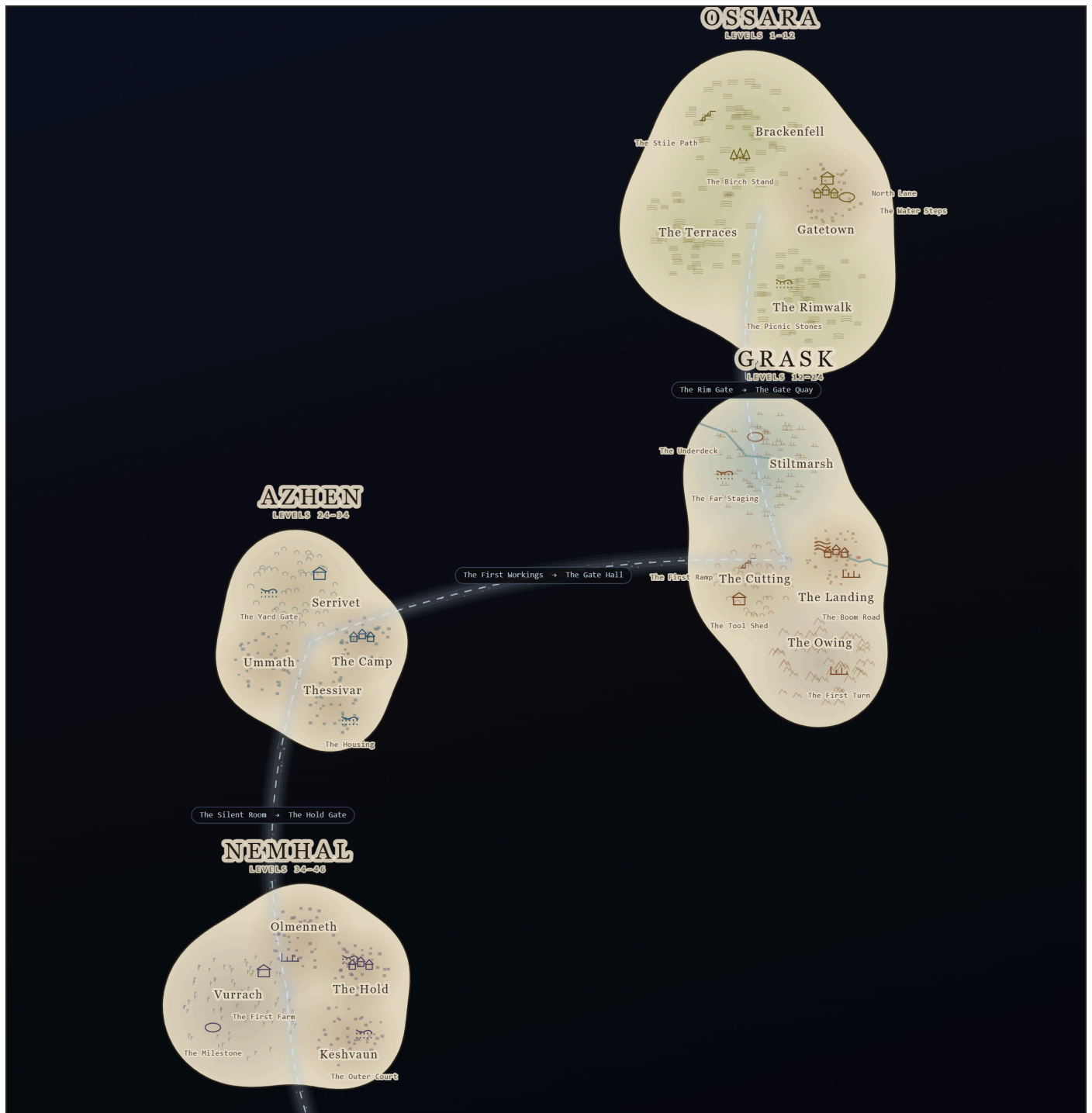


BEING A CHART OF THE FIVE INHABITED SHARDS

THE REACHES

Nothing lies between them but the Unlit, which is not a gap but the binding. Each Reach is drawn in the shape its own country makes: open ground runs wide, building stands close, and four crossings are the only ways between.





THE CROSSINGS

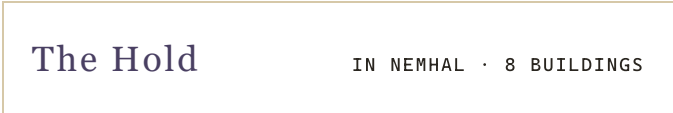
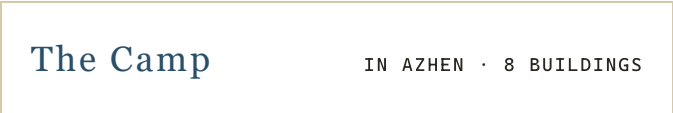
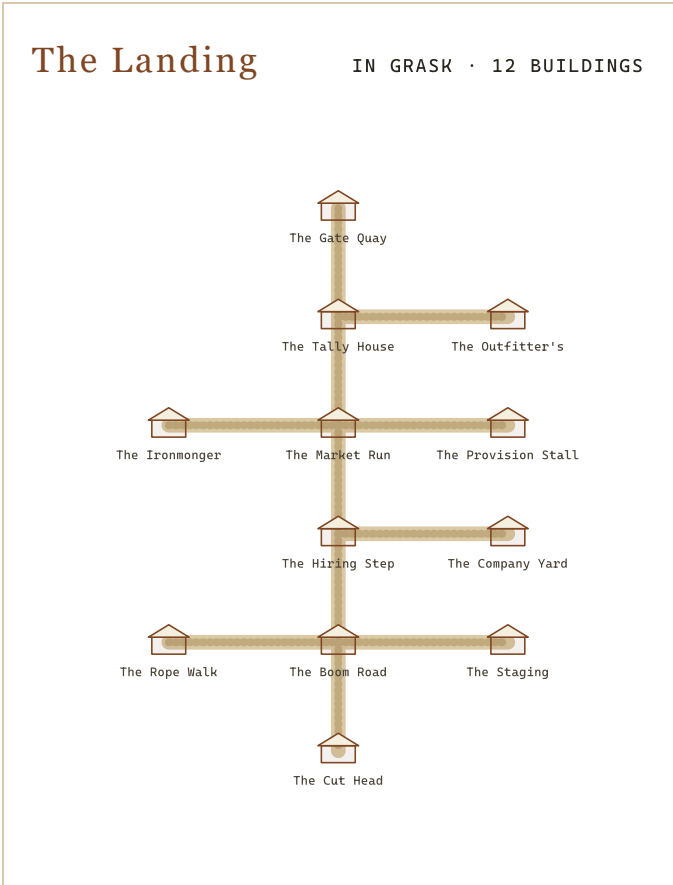
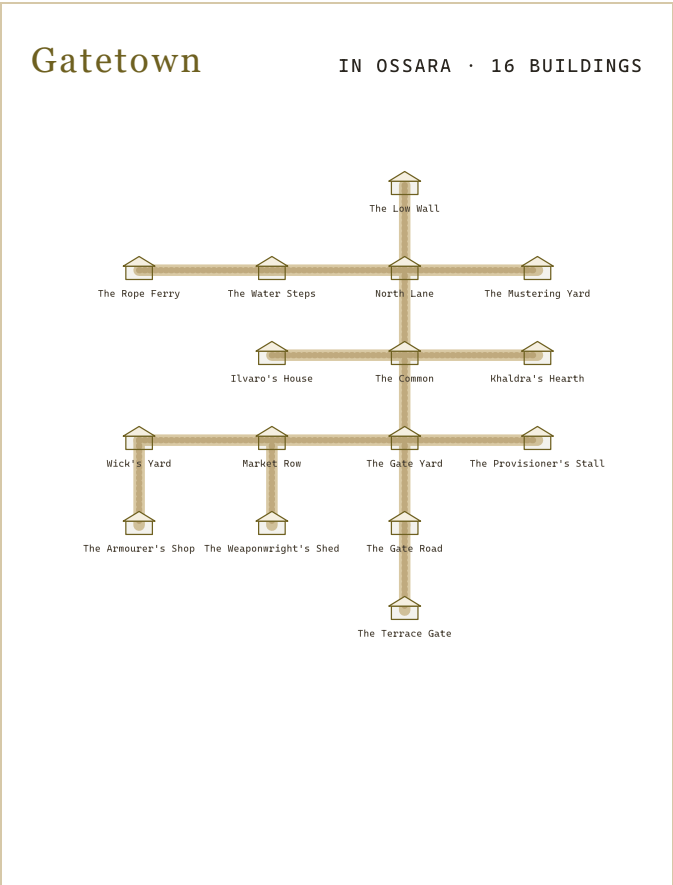
The Silent Room → The Hold Gate SOUTH, OUT OF AZHEN AND INTO NEMHAL

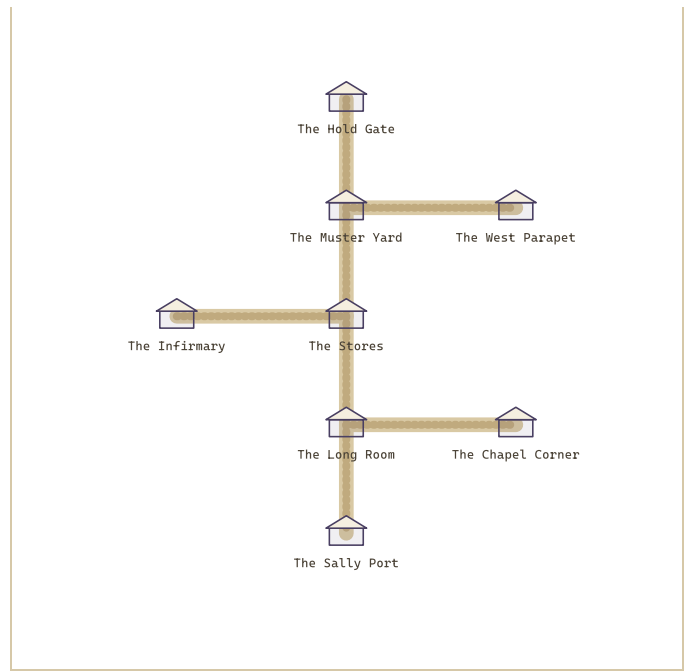
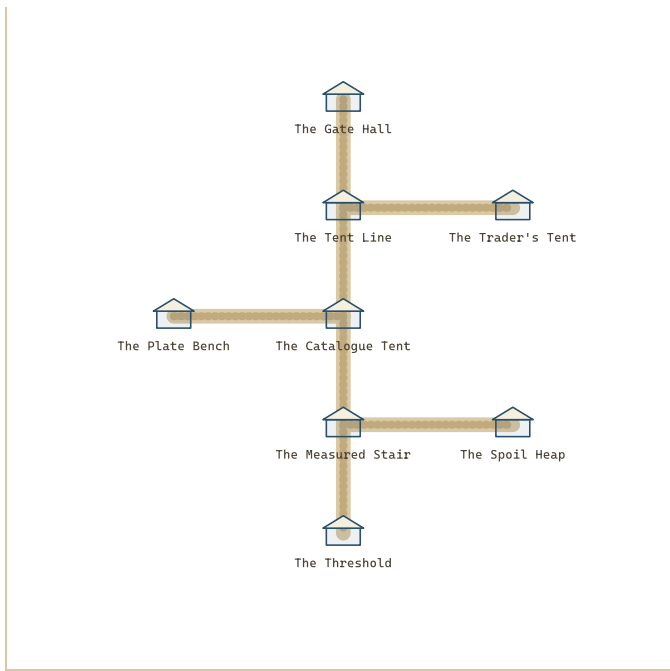
The First Workings → The Gate Hall WEST, OUT OF GRASK AND INTO AZHEN

The Standing Place → The Arrival SOUTH, OUT OF NEMHAL AND INTO THE UNLIT

The Rim Gate → The Gate Quay SOUTH, OUT OF OSSARA AND INTO GRASK

WHERE PEOPLE LIVE





THE READING OF IT

COUNTRY

Open ground — moor, wood, marsh, burn — is drawn wide. A district of building is drawn small and close, because it is somewhere you stand rather than somewhere you cross.

THE UNLIT

Everything between. Two places in it are thin enough to stand on, and those are drawn as light rather than as land.

MARKS

Where a stretch of country is not what the rest of it is — a quarry in the scrub, a wood, a stand of ruins — it is drawn as itself and named.

Every shape here is derived rather than chosen. A Reach's outline is the union of its zones, each sized by how many rooms it holds and how open they are, pulled together where they connect — so Ossara runs long because its country is a chain from the town to the rim, and Grask spreads because the Cutting is a hub with three arms. What a stretch of ground is was read from the terrain the rooms were drawn with.

